

Folk Dancing





About the Course

Learn basic steps for individual, couple, and/or group dances using traditional folk songs.

This topic is included in the following course(s): PE: Grades 1-3, PE: Grades 4-6

PE: Grades 1-3

Lessons specifically created for Grades 1-6. We recommend you make sure to include some sort of physical activity as breaks throughout your school day. If you already have sports or similar activities as a regular part of your life rhythms, these lessons are optional.

PE: Grades 4-6

Lessons specifically created for Grades 1-6. We recommend you make sure to include some sort of physical activity as breaks throughout your school day. If you already have sports or similar activities as a regular part of your life rhythms, these lessons are optional.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-6	Folk Dancing 1 time/week 20 min	The Book of Song Dances

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
PE: Grades 1-3				
Jump Rope	Free Play	Playground Songs & Rhymes	Free Play	Folk Dancing
PE: Grades 4-6				
Playground Games	Free Play/ Circuits	Sports	Free Play/ Circuits	Folk Dancing



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

PE: Grades 1-3

☐ Read the Introduction for Playground Songs & Rhymes p.5

☐ Bookmark the song playlist on SoundCloud. These include songs for folk dances, playground songs and rhymes, and jump rope. Create a free SoundCloud account to use

offline. There are links to individual songs in lessons.

☐ Preview games and songs.

PE: Grades 4-6

☐ You may need to gather supplies for the activities, so plan accordingly.

Folk Dancing

☐ Read the Introduction for The Book of Song Dances p.4-9.

☐ Bookmark the video folder of folk dances.

☐ Preview dance video; learn beforehand to teach students.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Folk Dancing



The Book of Song Dances



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Folk Dancing

∞ [Video Folder of Folk Dances](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Folk Dancing

How To Teach



Overview

Mason emphasized that being physically fit is just as important as being mentally and spiritually fit. She used a combination of Swedish Drill (calisthenic exercises done to music or military-style commands), playground games, sports, dance, free play, and afternoon walks to make sure students had time for vigorous exercise every single day.



Introduce

Teach students the new song, dance, or sport. Tutorials are often provided.



Practice

Play your new game, practice your new dance, sing your new rhyme, etc.!

Folk Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 1

WEEK 1

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 1

Great Big House

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

PREP: Teaching the song dance is much easier if you split up the skills. Teach the song first, then teach the dance slowly while counting the beat. Once those are mastered separately, you can try putting them together. Review Great Big House on p.30. Listen to the song, watch the demo, and learn the dance. Group instructions and partner variation are available.

→ INTRO

Say: Today, we are going to learn a new song and dance called Great Big House. We will listen to the song one time, then play it again and sing along.

→ LISTEN

∞ Audio Link: Great Big House

∞ Audio Link: Great Big House (piano only)

→ VIEW

Watch the demo and learn dance movements. Group Instructions and Partner Variation are available.

∞ Video Link: Great Big House

WEEK 2

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 2

Great Big House

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Great Big House

→ VIEW

Learn the steps to the dance, one part at a time.

∞ Video Link: Great Big House

WEEK 3

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 3

Great Big House

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Great Big House

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice the dance while listening to the song.

∞ Video Link: Great Big House

WEEK 4

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 4

Great Big House

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Great Big House

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Great Big House

WEEK 5

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 5

Great Big House

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Great Big House

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Great Big House

Folk Dancing

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Term 1

WEEK 6

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 6

Brother Come and Dance

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

PREP: Teaching the song dance is much easier if you split up the skills. Teach the song first, then teach the dance slowly while counting the beat. Once those are mastered separately, you can try putting them together. Review Brother Come and Dance on p.51. Listen to the song, watch the demo, and learn the dance. Group instructions and partner variation are available.

→ INTRO

Say: Today, we are going to learn a new song and dance called Brother Come and Dance. We will listen to the song one time, then play it again and sing along.

→ LISTEN

∞ Audio Links: Brother Come and Dance

→ VIEW

Watch the demo and learn dance movements. Group Instructions and Partner Variation are available.

∞ Video Link: Brother Come and Dance

WEEK 7

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 7

Brother Come and Dance

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brother Come and Dance

→ VIEW

Learn the steps to the dance, one part at a time.

∞ Video Link: Brother Come and Dance

WEEK 8

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 8

Brother Come and Dance

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brother Come and Dance

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice the dance while listening to the song.

∞ Video Link: Brother Come and Dance

WEEK 9

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 9

Brother Come and Dance

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brother Come and Dance

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Brother Come and Dance

WEEK 10

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 10

Brother Come and Dance

Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brother Come and Dance

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Brother Come and Dance

Term 1	
WEEK 11 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 11 Brother Come and Dance Materials: The Book of Song Dances → RECAP Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music. ∞ Audio Links: Brother Come and Dance → DANCE Practice the dance while singing the song. ∞ Video Link: Brother Come and Dance	
WEEK 12 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Book of Song Dances	

Folk Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 2

WEEK 1

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 13

Old Joe Clark

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

PREP: Teaching the song dance is much easier if you split up the skills. Teach the song first, then teach the dance slowly while counting the beat. Once those are mastered separately, you can try putting them together. Review Old Joe Clark p.36-37. Listen to the song, watch the demo, and learn the dance. Group instructions and partner variation are available.

→ INTRO

Say: Today, we are going to learn a new song and dance called Old Joe Clark. We will listen to the song one time, then play it again and sing along.

→ LISTEN

∞ Audio Links: Old Joe Clark

→ VIEW

Watch the demo and learn dance movements. Group Instructions and Partner Variation are available.

∞ Video Link: Old Joe Clark

WEEK 2

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 14

Old Joe Clark

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Old Joe Clark

→ VIEW

Learn the steps to the dance, one part at a time.

∞ Video Link: Old Joe Clark

WEEK 3

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 15

Old Joe Clark

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Old Joe Clark

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice the dance while listening to the song.

∞ Video Link: Old Joe Clark

WEEK 4

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 16

Old Joe Clark

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Old Joe Clark

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Old Joe Clark

WEEK 5

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 17

Old Joe Clark

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Old Joe Clark

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Old Joe Clark

Folk Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 2

WEEK 6

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 18

Brown Eyed Mary

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

PREP: Teaching the song dance is much easier if you split up the skills. Teach the song first, then teach the dance slowly while counting the beat. Once those are mastered separately, you can try putting them together. Review Brown Eyed Mary on p.52-53. Listen to the song, watch the demo, and learn the dance. Group instructions and partner variation are available.

→ INTRO

Say: Today, we are going to learn a new song and dance called Brown Eyed Mary. We will listen to the song one time, then play it again and sing along.

→ LISTEN

∞ Audio Links: Brown Eyed Mary

→ VIEW

Watch the demo and learn dance movements. Group Instructions and Partner Variation are available.

∞ Video Link: Brown Eyed Mary

WEEK 7

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 19

Brown Eyed Mary

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brown Eyed Mary

→ VIEW

Learn the steps to the dance, one part at a time.

∞ Video Link: Brown Eyed Mary

WEEK 8

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 20

Brown Eyed Mary

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brown Eyed Mary

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice the dance while listening to the song.

∞ Video Link: Brown Eyed Mary

WEEK 9

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 21

Brown Eyed Mary

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brown Eyed Mary

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Brown Eyed Mary

WEEK 10

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 22

Brown Eyed Mary

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Brown Eyed Mary

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Brown Eyed Mary

Term 2	
WEEK 11 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 23 Brown Eyed Mary Materials: The Book of Song Dances → RECAP Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music. ∞ Audio Links: Brown Eyed Mary → DANCE Practice the dance while singing the song. ∞ Video Link: Brown Eyed Mary	
WEEK 12 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Book of Song Dances	

Folk Dancing

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#) 

Term 3

WEEK 1

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 25

Billy, Billy

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

PREP: Teaching the song dance is much easier if you split up the skills. Teach the song first, then teach the dance slowly while counting the beat. Once those are mastered separately, you can try putting them together. Review Billy, Billy p.72 (original), p.68 (revised edition). Listen to the song, watch the demo, and learn the dance. Group instructions and partner variation are available.

→ **INTRO**

Say: Today, we are going to learn a new song and dance called Billy, Billy. We will listen to the song one time, then play it again and sing along.

→ **LISTEN**

∞ Audio Links: Billy, Billy

→ **VIEW**

Watch the demo and learn dance movements. Group Instructions and Partner Variation are available.

∞ Video Link: Billy, Billy

WEEK 2

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 26

Billy, Billy

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ **RECAP**

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Billy, Billy

→ **VIEW**

Learn the steps to the dance, one part at a time.

∞ Video Link: Billy, Billy

WEEK 3

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 27

Billy, Billy

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ **RECAP**

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Billy, Billy

→ **LISTEN & PRACTICE**

Practice the dance while listening to the song.

∞ Video Link: Billy, Billy

WEEK 4

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 28

Billy, Billy

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ **RECAP**

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Billy, Billy

→ **DANCE**

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Billy, Billy

WEEK 5

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 29

Billy, Billy

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ **RECAP**

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Billy, Billy

→ **DANCE**

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Billy, Billy

Term 3

WEEK 6

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 30

Paw Paw Patch

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

PREP: Teaching the song dance is much easier if you split up the skills. Teach the song first, then teach the dance slowly while counting the beat. Once those are mastered separately, you can try putting them together. Review Paw Paw Patch on p.92-93 (original), p.86 (revised edition). Listen to the song, watch the demo, and learn the dance. Group instructions and partner variation are available.

→ INTRO

Say: Today, we are going to learn a new song and dance called Paw Paw Patch. We will listen to the song one time, then play it again and sing along.

→ LISTEN

∞ Audio Links: Paw Paw Patch

→ VIEW

Watch the demo and learn dance movements. Group Instructions and Partner Variation are available.

∞ Video Link: Paw Paw Patch

WEEK 7

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 31

Paw Paw Patch

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Paw Paw Patch

→ VIEW

Learn the steps to the dance, one part at a time.

∞ Video Link: Paw Paw Patch

WEEK 8

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 32

Paw Paw Patch

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Paw Paw Patch

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Practice the dance while listening to the song.

∞ Video Link: Paw Paw Patch

WEEK 9

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 33

Paw Paw Patch

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Paw Paw Patch

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Paw Paw Patch

WEEK 10

20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 34

Paw Paw Patch

 Materials: The Book of Song Dances

→ RECAP

Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music.

∞ Audio Links: Paw Paw Patch

→ DANCE

Practice the dance while singing the song.

∞ Video Link: Paw Paw Patch

Term 3	
WEEK 11 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 35 Paw Paw Patch Materials: The Book of Song Dances → RECAP Listen to the song once and sing along. Then sing the song without the music. ∞ Audio Links: Paw Paw Patch → DANCE Practice the dance while singing the song. ∞ Video Link: Paw Paw Patch	
WEEK 12 20m Folk Dancing - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Book of Song Dances	

Folk Dancing

Examination

Term 1 · Perform the song and dance for Great Big House OR Brother Come and Dance.

Term 2 · Perform the song and dance for Old Joe Clark OR Brown Eyed Mary.

Term 3 · Perform the song and dance for Billy, Billy OR Paw Paw Patch.